carefully focused on material components of the Wall. Though he detoured from his usual practices, he pursued on-site study of such components of the Wall's renovation to further explore the themes of his larger body of work. Tajiri's images offer an extensive and ostensible visual inventory. Across the produced images that he captured in 1969–70, Tajiri presents an abundance of disparate building materials, border components, and social circumstances of division that together exploded the notion of a singular Berlin Wall. Specifically, Tajiri views the intended and unintended elements of concrete, steel, brick, wood, water, wire, debris, trees, gravel, sand, shrubs, rubble, and trash on the scene. He encounters multiple forms of machinery and modes of transport, including boats, excavators, trains, bicycles, trolleys, and cars, routinely parked perpendicular to the Wall in mundane fashion. He challenges notions of isolation along the border by playing between the physicality of the Wall and the social activity around it.

To locate a starting point days into his project, Tajiri drove to the southeast edge of West Berlin's American sector. There, he ascended an observation deck and pointed his 35mm camera downward at the wall system's outer barrier. Tajiri did not reach out to touch the Wall for fear of rebuke from the border guards, but he could explore the tangible components and contours in other ways, drawing close enough to fully observe and render his surroundings. He began to register a sort of "emotional value of volume," in Borglum's terms, without sculpted touch or formal casting. He varied his perspective, beginning with a view at the Wall from the top down. Tajiri was enthralled not only by the Wall's spectacular form, but also, and perhaps even more so, by its total environs.[40]

In these opening frames, he glimpses three uppermost concrete slabs placed directly onto one another, the steel support beams that reinforced the barricade and sent rust marks to its stone surface, and a pair of rounded cylinder tops that crowned each stack, unevenly but in tandem. The ground level is not visible on the western side, but a strip of dirt over the Wall is within prominent view. Tajiri indexes the smoothed dirt of the death strip but also includes patches with rocks jutting out on the ground. As a single image, this would offer an inversion of the political reality of the Wall, a structure seen chiefly from above and as placeless in its perspective. But in the beginning of an ensemble of views, he scoured the Wall's presence for the same sort of physical qualities he would see in the middle of the city—a range of structural feats that are foreboding and repeated emphatically to